

Parimala Alva, Ph.D.

AI LEARNING & ENABLEMENT SPECIALIST | TECHNICAL EDUCATOR

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AI Enablement Portfolio: <https://portfolio-hub-git-main-pa11aajs-projects.vercel.app/>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

PhD-credentialed educator and AI specialist with over 10 years of experience delivering technical learning programs for a diverse range of adult learners across hybrid, virtual, and in-person environments. Combines deep subject-matter expertise in Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning and GenAI workflows with hands-on experience developing interactive digital assets, LMS-based learning materials, and workflow automation tools that aid adult learners quickly assimilate AI concepts. Integrates higher education experience with 5 years of enterprise software background and cross-functional collaboration alongside global stakeholders.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Learning & Development:** Adult Learning Principles, Virtual & In-Person Delivery, Learning Material Development, Learning Pathways, Workshop Facilitation, Learner Engagement
- **AI & Technical Enablement:** Generative AI, RAG, Agentic Workflows, Workflow Automation, Python, Technical Documentation
- **Program Operations & Tech:** LMS Administration, Learner Progress Tracking, SharePoint, Microsoft Teams, Zoom, Excel (Pivot Tables, VLOOKUPS), PowerPoint, Cross-Functional Coordination

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Centennial College - Toronto, Canada | *Professor* | 2016 - Present

- Deliver, manage, and facilitate end-to-end technical learning programs and courses in Artificial Intelligence, Unix/Linux Operating Systems, Software Engineering, Web Development, across in-person, online, and hybrid formats.
- Apply adult learning principles to translate complex AI and software engineering concepts into structured learning pathways, hands-on lab exercises, and learning aids.
- Administer learning assets, track learner progress, evaluate assignments, and manage course operations within digital Learning Management Systems such as Brightspace and Blackboard LMS.
- Support and mentor diverse cohorts through structured troubleshooting, technical capability building, and hands-on tool adoption.
- Continuously refine instructional materials and delivery methods based on learner evaluations and performance metrics.

University of Hertfordshire - Hatfield, UK | *Visiting Lecturer* | 2012 - 2014

- Supervised undergraduate technical projects, providing structured milestones, project planning support, and ongoing academic guidance.
- Delivered hands-on lab sessions for Database Driven Systems, reinforcing applied skills and software development concepts.
- Tracked learner performance, evaluated technical deliverables, and provided feedback to improve course outcomes.

Robert Half Technology - Calgary, Canada | *Software Consultant* | Mar 2010 - Jul 2010

- Enhanced billing system workflows and developed customer portal features for a satellite communications client to streamline operations and improve user access to real-time information.
- Consulted directly with business stakeholders to identify operational pain points, translating user needs into system enhancements and workflow improvements.
- Created user-focused educational materials and job aids to support smooth feature adoption and system transition.
- Facilitated one-on-one enablement sessions and user support to ensure stakeholders confidently adopted new portal capabilities and operational tools.

Metafore - Calgary, Canada | *Programmer Analyst* | 2008 - 2009

- Built features for job order management systems within the oil and gas drilling industry, optimizing operational workflows to enhance overall process management.
- Partnered with end users and business stakeholders to uncover process bottlenecks and deliver targeted system fixes that simplified day-to-day operations.
- Developed clear reference documentation and instructional guidance to help non-technical users navigate updated system features.
- Provided hands-on, one-on-one coaching to accelerate technology adoption and ensure seamless integration into daily field and office routines.

Infosys - India | *Software Engineer* | 2004 - 2008

- Developed and delivered enterprise software solutions across diverse client domains including Healthcare (Cross Country Healthcare), Transportation (Canadian Pacific Railways), and Insurance (First Canadian Title).
- Consulted with business stakeholders to analyze domain-specific pain points, gathering operational requirements to design targeted system workflows and integrations.
- Authored user-friendly training resources, technical documentation, and job aids to support stakeholders in understanding and adopting new application features.
- Provided one-on-one and small group enablement to guide end users through system updates, ensuring smooth technology adoption and minimal workflow disruption.
- Coordinated communication and deliverables between Canadian stakeholders and offshore technical teams, managing timelines, documentation, and stakeholder expectations across distributed environments

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

PhD in Computer Science - *University of Hertfordshire, UK* | 2012 - 2016

MSc in Artificial Intelligence and Robotics - *University of Hertfordshire, UK* | 2011 - 2012

B.E. in Computer Science - *VTU, India* | 2001 – 2005

Certifications:

IBM RAG and Agentic AI Professional Certificate (*Coursera*, May 2026),

Responsible AI Data Management, Explainable AI in Python (*Datacamp*, 2025)

*All educational qualifications are **WES-verified**

FEATURED AI ENABLEMENT & LEARNING PROJECTS

AI On-boarding Employee/Engineer (Live Demo: <https://ai-onboarding-engineer.vercel.app/>)

- Turns any set of documents into a hands-on, self-paced onboarding course that teaches, tests, and grades learners automatically.
- Runs as a three-step pipeline: design a syllabus, generate a lab, then review the learner's answer.
- Each step retrieves grounded context from a Pinecone vector store, so lessons, quizzes, and reference sheets stay traceable back to real source material rather than the model's own guesses.
- Every step produces a short-answer challenge, a 4-option auto-graded quiz, and a downloadable cheat-sheet together, using structured, validated outputs instead of free-form text.
- Session state lives in Postgres, so the whole app runs as stateless serverless functions on Vercel.
- Point the ingestion pipeline at any docs or codebase, and it becomes the material learners are onboarded against.

AI Skills Navigator & L&D Ops Assistant (Live Demo: <https://ai-skills-navigator.vercel.app/>)

- Built a dedicated web application using Next.js (App Router), TypeScript, and Tailwind CSS designed to automate core L&D operational workflows.
- Generates personalized 30, 60, and 90-day AI training plans based on employee department and comfort level.
- Integrated an automated support chatbot to instantly resolve learner questions regarding schedules, prerequisites, and continuing education credits.
- Built an automated survey analysis module that transforms uploaded feedback into structured sentiment summaries and actionable recommendations for program coordinators.